

Daily Bible Note

Date: September 5, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Psalm 119:65–72

65 You have dealt well with Your servant, O LORD, according to Your word.

66 Teach me good judgment and knowledge, for I believe Your commandments.

67 Before I was afflicted I went astray, but now I keep Your word.

68 You are good, and do good; teach me Your statutes.

69 The proud have forged a lie against me, but I will keep Your precepts with my whole heart.

70 Their heart is as fat as grease, but I delight in Your law.

71 It is good for me that I have been afflicted, that I may learn Your statutes.

72 The law of Your mouth is better to me than thousands of coins of gold and silver.

II. Key Summary

- The psalmist says the LORD has dealt well with His servant according to His word, then asks God for good judgment and knowledge, on the grounds that "I believe Your commandments" (vv. 65–66).

- He looks back at his own story: before he was afflicted he went astray, but now he keeps God's word; then he says "You are good, and do good," and asks God to teach him His statutes (vv. 67–68).

- In the previous section (Psalm 119:57–64) he said he sought God's favor with his whole heart and kept God's word; in this section (vv. 65–72) he says the same thing while under attack: the proud have forged a lie against him and their heart is as fat as grease, yet he will keep God's precepts with his whole heart and delight in God's law, and he says it is good for him that he has been afflicted and that the law of God's mouth is better than thousands of coins of gold and silver (vv. 69–72).

III. Passage Analysis

Going astray often happens when life is going well

Often our trials act as a thorn hedge to keep us in the good pasture, but our prosperity is a gap through which we go astray. [1]

In verse 67 the psalmist lays out his own order of events: first he "went astray," and that was "before I was afflicted," and only then comes "but now I keep Your word." The stretch when he drifted was the stretch before any of the hardship.

After the affliction, what he says out loud is "You are good"

Despite the affliction — which we should regard as genuine — he proclaimed, "You are good, and do good." In fact, he even wanted more instruction from God, saying "Teach me Your statutes." This shows how confident he was in the goodness of God. [2]

Verse 68's "You are good, and do good" comes straight after the affliction of verse 67, and what he asks for in that same verse is "Teach me Your statutes." By verse 71 he says it again: "It is good for me that I have been afflicted, that I may learn Your statutes."

IV. Reflection Question

When life is going well, how often do you think about God?

The psalmist says that before he was afflicted he went astray (v. 67); he asked the God who is "good, and do[es] good" to "teach me Your statutes" (v. 68), and later he said the affliction was good for him, so that he might learn God's statutes (v. 71) — even Jesus "learned obedience from what he suffered" (Hebrews 5:8).

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik's commentary on Psalm 119 (quoting Charles Spurgeon), <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/psalm-119/>

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik's commentary on Psalm 119,

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/psalm-119/>

[3] Enduring Word, David Guzik's commentary on Psalm 119 (quoting James Boice, Hebrews 5:8), <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/psalm-119/>